

EA Prerequisite: Fundamental Refrigerant Management

This prerequisite applies to

- ▶ BD+C: New Construction
- ▶ BD+C: Core & Shell
- ▶ BD+C: Schools
- ▶ BD+C: Retail
- ▶ BD+C: Data Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Warehouses & Distribution Centers
- ▶ BD+C: Hospitality
- ▶ BD+C: Healthcare

INTENT

To reduce ozone depletion and global warming potential and support early compliance with the Kigali Amendment to the Montreal Protocol, while minimizing direct contributions to climate change.

REQUIREMENTS

NC, CS, SCHOOLS, RETAIL, DATA CENTERS, WAREHOUSES & DISTRIBUTION CENTERS, HOSPITALITY, HEALTHCARE

Do not use chlorofluorocarbon (CFC) or hydro chlorofluorocarbon (HCFC) -based refrigerants in new heating, ventilating, air-conditioning, and refrigeration (HVAC&R) systems. When reusing existing HVAC&R equipment, complete a comprehensive CFC and/or HCFC phase-out conversion before project completion. Phase-out plans extending beyond the project completion date will be considered on their merits.

Existing small HVAC&R units (defined as containing less than 0.5 pound [225 grams] of refrigerant) and other equipment, such as standard refrigerators, small water coolers, and any other equipment that contains less than 0.5 pound (225 grams) of refrigerant, are exempt.

GUIDANCE

Refer to the LEED v4 reference guide, with the following edits and additions:

Behind the Intent

Hydrochlorofluorocarbons (HCFCs) have shorter atmospheric lives than CFCs, but they still contribute to ozone depletion. Similar to CFCs, HCFCs have phase-out dates scheduled under the Montreal Protocol.

Both HCFCs and CFCs must be addressed to meet this prerequisite. Wherever CFCs are mentioned in the LEED v4 reference guide, the guidance also applies to HCFCs.

Further Explanation

Connection to Ongoing Building Performance

- ▶ LEED O+M EA credit Enhanced Refrigerant Management: Despite successful global adoption of the Montreal Protocol, large volumes of CFCs and HCFCs remain in circulation and contribute to stratospheric ozone depletion. Completing a comprehensive CFC phase-out conversion for HVAC&R equipment reused in the project helps ensure that refrigerants are correctly disposed of and do not escape into the atmosphere.